

TRIBAL ANTHROPOLOGY — PYQ BUILDING BLOCKS

Paper 2, Units 6.1–9.3 | 20 Modular Answer Blocks | Based on PYQ Analysis (2014–2024)

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PYQ FREQUENCY ANALYSIS (2014–2024)

Theme	Years Asked	Marks	Priority
FRA 2006 & Forest Policy	2014, 2016, 2018, 2019, 2021, 2024	10–20	★★★★★
Constitutional Safeguards (V/VI Schedule)	2014–2024 (almost every year)	10–20	★★★★★
Role of Anthropology in Development	2014–2023 (every year)	15–20	★★★★★
PVTGs	2014, 2017, 2023, 2024	10–20	★★★★★
NGOs in Tribal Development	2014, 2015, 2016, 2019, 2021	10–20	★★★★★
Ethnicity & Ethnic Conflicts	2014, 2017, 2020, 2023, 2024	10–20	★★★★
Tribal Unrest & Movements	2014, 2018, 2021, 2022	10–20	★★★★
Land Alienation	2014, 2015, 2020, 2021	15–20	★★★★
Displacement & R&R	2017, 2018, 2020, 2021, 2023	15–20	★★★★
Impact of Religions	Every year (one religion)	10–15	★★★★
Health & Nutrition	2017, 2021, 2024	10–20	★★★★
PESA & Gram Sabha	2018, 2022, 2024	10–15	★★★★
Communalism & Regionalism	2015, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2024	10–20	★★★★
Concept of Tribe / Tribe vs ST	2016, 2018, 2021	10	★★★
Elwin–Ghurye Debate	2015, 2022	10–20	★★★
Dev Programmes (TSP/ITDP)	2016, 2017, 2019, 2022	15–20	★★★
Bio-genetic Variability	2014, 2016	10	★★★
Shifting Cultivation	2015, 2022	10–15	★★★
Tribe & Nation State	2017, 2019	15–20	★★★
OBCs	2017, 2018, 2023	10–15	★★★
Linguistic Classification	2020	10–15	★★

BB-01 CONCEPT OF TRIBE — DEFINITIONS & COLONIAL CONSTRUCT

PYQ: "Tribe as colonial construct" (2016/10), "Tribe and Scheduled Tribe" (2018/10), "Concept of tribe and Indian census" (2021/10), "Tribes are not homogeneous" (20)

Core Definitions

Scholar	Definition
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D.N. Majumdar	Social group with territorial affiliation, endogamous, no functional specialization, ruled by tribal officers, united by language/dialect, recognizes social distance with other tribes/castes
Imperial Gazetteer	Group of families bearing common name, common dialect, common territory, observing marriage taboos
L.P. Vidyarthi	Group speaking common dialect, observing uniform social customs, living in a particular geographical area

Tribe as Colonial Construct

- British created rigid "tribe" label for administrative classification of non-caste groups
- Criminal Tribes Act (1871)**: Branded communities as "criminal" — Pardhis, Sansis, Kanjars
- Census classifications (1891 onwards) froze fluid identities into fixed categories
- Andre Beteille**: "Tribe" is a colonial administrative category, not a natural social formation
- G.S. Ghurye (1943)**: Called tribes "backward Hindus" — denied separate identity
- Pre-colonial: Tribe-caste boundaries were fluid (Rajput-Bhil interaction, Gond kingdoms)

Tribe vs Scheduled Tribe

Aspect	Tribe	Scheduled Tribe
Nature	Anthropological/sociological concept	Legal/constitutional concept
Basis	Shared culture, territory, language, kinship	Presidential notification under Art. 342
Criteria	Academic — no single definition	Lokur Committee: 5 criteria
Gap	Many nomadic groups (DNTs) missed ST list	Some groups got ST for political reasons (pseudo-tribalism)

Tribe and Indian Census

- 1871: First enumeration under "forest tribes" | 1891: Separate "animist" category
- 1931: Last caste-based census — 25 million tribals | 2011: 10.43 crore STs (8.6%)
- Communities not notified as ST become statistically invisible
- Xaxa Committee (2014)**: Recommended revision of ST list, criticized outdated Lokur criteria

"Tribes Are Not Homogeneous"

- Linguistic**: 4 language families | **Economic**: Hunter-gatherers to artisans to pastoralists
- Racial**: Negrito, Proto-Australoid, Mongoloid | **Religious**: Animist, Hindu-syncretic, Christian, Buddhist
- Regional**: NE (clan-based, democratic) vs Central (hierarchical) vs Island (isolated, pre-Neolithic)

BB-02

BIO-GENETIC VARIABILITY

PYQ: "Bio-genetic variability of Indian tribes" (2014/10, 2016/10)

Definition: Genetic differences among populations from gene-environment interaction over evolutionary time. Reflected in blood groups, hemoglobin types, skin color, DNA markers.

Racial Classification

Race	Traits	Examples	Share
Negrito	Short stature, dark skin, woolly hair, thick lips	Onge, Jarawa, Sentinelese	Smallest
Proto-Australoid	Medium stature, dark skin, curly hair, muscular	Chenchu, Gond, Santhal, Munda, Oraon	Largest
Mongoloid	Yellowish-brown skin, flat face, epicanthic fold	Garo, Naga, Kuki, Khasi, Mizo	NE India

Key Studies

Study	Finding
B.S. Guha (1935)	Classified Indian population into 6 racial types; mapped tribes to Negrito, Proto-Australoid, Mongoloid
mtDNA Studies	Austro-Asiatic tribes show greater genetic diversity than Dravidian → older ancestry
Vasava-Kotwalia (1985)	No major genetic difference within same ethnic group in same region → regional homogeneity
AP Tribal Study (1981)	Geographically close tribes share genetic similarities → regional gene flow
Sickle Cell Studies	High frequency in Gonds, Bhils → natural selection favoring malaria resistance

Key conclusion: Indian tribes = "living laboratory of human genetic variation." Isolation + endogamy → genetic drift → unique allele frequencies. But gene flow prevents total isolation.

BB-03

LINGUISTIC CLASSIFICATION

PYQ: "Linguistic classification of Indian tribes" (2020/15)

Family	Region	Tribes	Key Features
Austro-Asiatic (Munda & Mon-Khmer)	Chotanagpur, Central-East India; Meghalaya	Santhals, Mundas, Ho, Khasia, Korku, Khasi	Oldest linguistic stratum; Santali = largest (7M+ speakers, Ol Chiki script)
Dravidian	Central & South India	Gond, Oraon (Kurukh), Toda, Malto, Chenchu	Pre-Aryan; Kurukh = northernmost Dravidian tribal language
Tibeto-Burman	NE India, Himalayan belt	Naga, Mizo, Bodo, Garo, Lepcha, Kuki	Tonal; enormous diversity (Naga = 60+ dialects); many endangered
Indo-Aryan	Scattered	Bhil (Bhili), Warli, Tharu	Originally non-IA speakers who shifted; Bhili retains archaic features

Scholars: George A. Grierson (Linguistic Survey, 1903-28: 179 languages, 544 dialects) | S.K. Chatterji (Austro-Asiatic = earliest linguistic group)

Endangered Languages

- UNESCO: 197 Indian languages endangered | Great Andamanese: <10 speakers | Bo: Extinct (2010)
- Only 2 tribal languages in 8th Schedule: Santali & Bodo (out of 22)
- Language = strongest marker of tribal identity; language loss = cultural loss

BB-04

SHIFTING CULTIVATION

PYQ: "Socio-economic characteristics of shifting cultivators" (2015/10), "Livelihood vs environmental degradation — shifting cultivation" (2022/15)

Also called: Jhum (NE), Podu (AP/Odisha), Bewar/Dahiya (MP), Kumari (Western Ghats). Slash-and-burn: clear → burn → cultivate 2-3 years → abandon → fallow 10-20 years.

Socio-Economic Characteristics

- 1. **Subsistence economy** — food for family, not market
- 2. **Community-based** — communal land ownership, collective decisions
- 3. **Simple technology** — dao, digging sticks, hoe; no plough
- 4. **Ecologically embedded** — intimate knowledge of soil, seasons
- 5. **Mixed cropping** — 20-40 crops (polyculture), natural pest control
- 6. **Egalitarian** — no landlord-tenant; equal land access
- 7. **Cultural-ritual integration** — agri calendar = festival calendar (Wangala, Garos)
- 8. **Low population density required** — needs large forest tracts

Environmental Debate

View	Argument
Degradation	Reduced fallow (20 → 3-5 years) → deforestation, soil erosion
Sustainability	Long-fallow jhum is sustainable; Ramakrishnan (1992) : comparable to secondary succession
Middle ground	Problem = compressed fallow due to population pressure + restricted forest access

Apatani model (Ziro Valley): Wet rice + fish culture in terraced fields — globally recognized sustainable alternative. NITI Aayog (2018): gradual transition, not sudden ban.

BB-05 LAND ALIENATION

PYQ: "Impact of land alienation on Central India tribes" (2014/15), "Constitutional provisions for land alienation" (2015/20), "Problems of land alienation" (2020/15)

Definition: Transfer of tribal land to non-tribals through legal, semi-legal, or illegal means.

6 Causes

1. **Colonial land policies:** Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari — imposed individual ownership on communal systems
2. **Moneylender-trader nexus:** Usurious loans → land mortgage → forfeiture
3. **Market penetration:** Cash economy undermined subsistence
4. **Government acquisition:** Dams, mines, industries, sanctuaries
5. **Encroachment by non-tribals:** In-migration, benami transactions
6. **Weak legal literacy:** Tribals unaware of protective legislation

Consequences

- **Economic:** Landlessness → bonded labor, poverty trap (B.D. Sharma: "destitution spiral")
- **Social:** Breakdown of community bonds | **Cultural:** Sacred groves, burial sites lost
- **Psychological:** Anomie, identity crisis → alcoholism, suicide
- **Political:** Santhal Rebellion (1855), Birsa Munda (1899), contemporary Naxalism

Legal Protections

Provision	Protection
Fifth Schedule	Governor can prohibit/restrict land transfer in Scheduled Areas
Sixth Schedule	ADCs control land allotment in NE tribal areas
PESA (1996)	Gram Sabha must approve land acquisition
FRA (2006)	Recognizes IFR and CFR
CNTA (1908)	Restricts tribal land transfer in Jharkhand
SPTA (1949)	Same for Santhal Pargana

Scholars: B.D. Sharma ("Unfinished Task") | Walter Fernandes (40M displaced, 85% not rehabilitated; tribals = 40% of displaced but 8% of population) | K.S. Singh (land alienation = primary driver of tribal movements)

BB-06 TRIBAL EDUCATION

PYQ: "Constraints for low literacy" (2015/15), "Issues in tribal education" (2019/10), "Challenges in educational attainment of STs" (2021/15)

Stats: ST literacy 59% vs national 73% | ST female literacy 49.4% vs 65.5% | Dropout (I-X): 62% vs 47% | Exception: Mizoram 91.3%

Constraints

Socio-Cultural	Economic	Psychological
Medium of instruction not mother tongue	Poverty — children needed as labor	Discrimination by non-tribal teachers/students
Curriculum alien to tribal worldview	Hidden costs (uniform, books, transport)	Culturally alien hostel environment
School calendar vs agricultural cycle	Opportunity cost of schooling	Comprehension gap → failure → dropout
Gender discrimination; early marriage	Malnutrition → poor cognition	No academic support at home (first-gen learners)
Fear of cultural alienation	Remote — no schools within walking distance	

Government Interventions & Way Forward

- **EMRS:** 740 model residential schools sanctioned | **Ashram Schools** | **Post-Matric Scholarships**
- **MLE (Multilingual Education):** Odisha model — Saora, Kui languages
- **Way forward:** Mother-tongue education (UNESCO) + culturally rooted curriculum + tribal teachers + address poverty-nutrition nexus

BB-07

HEALTH & NUTRITION

PYQ: "Impact of displacement on health" (2017/20), "Malnutrition in tribal India" (2021/15), "Stunting and wasting among tribal children" (2024/10), "Holistic health — COVID-19" (2024/20)

Key Statistics (NFHS-5)

Indicator	STs	National
IMR (per 1000)	44.4	34.9
Stunting (children)	40.3%	35.5%
Wasting (children)	23.2%	19.3%
Anemia (women)	67.6%	57%

Causes of Stunting & Wasting

1. Chronic malnutrition — shift from diverse forest foods to mono-crop
2. Loss of traditional food sources (deforestation → MFP loss)
3. Poverty + poor WASH → repeated infections → malabsorption
4. Maternal malnutrition → low birth weight → intergenerational cycle
5. Inadequate healthcare access + displacement effect

Traditional Health Knowledge (TEK)

- 7,500+ plant species used | **Irula:** 90% of India's anti-venom | **Kani:** Arogyapacha → TBGRI benefit-sharing
- **COVID-19:** Digital divide, lockdown disrupted MFP + health services; isolated tribes naturally protected
- **Lesson:** Decentralized community-based health + TEK integration

BB-08 FOREST POLICY & FRA 2006

PYQ: "Forest policies 1878 to 2006" (2024/15), "FRA significance & implementation" (2018/15), "FRA impact on livelihood" (2021/20), "Forest policy and tribes" (2014/10)

Evolution of Forest Policy

Year	Policy/Act	Impact on Tribes
1865	Indian Forest Act	First state control; "government forests" concept
1878	IFA (Amended)	Reserved/Protected/Village forests; criminalized tribal use
1894	Forest Policy	Forests for state revenue — no tribal rights
1927	Indian Forest Act	Consolidated colonial law; restricted jhum, grazing, MFP
1952	National Forest Policy	33% cover target; national interest > local rights
1980	Forest Conservation Act	Central approval for diversion; further restricted access
1988	National Forest Policy	First recognition of tribal dependence; JFM concept
2006	FRA	"Historic correction of historical injustice"

FRA 2006 — Key Provisions

1. **IFR:** Title to land cultivated before Dec 2005 — max 4 hectares
2. **CFR:** Community ownership of forests; right to collect, use, sell MFP
3. **PVTG habitat rights:** Entire habitat as community forest resource
4. **Right to protect & manage:** Gram Sabha as forest authority
5. **Forest villages** → **revenue villages:** Full amenities
6. **No eviction without settlement** of rights recognition process

Implementation Challenges

- Low claim settlement: ~47L filed, only ~22L titles distributed; CFR lags behind IFR
- Forest bureaucracy resistance + weak Gram Sabha capacity + state variation
- Conflict with FCA 1980 & Wildlife Act 1972 | SC Feb 2019 eviction order (stayed)

Success story — Gadchiroli, Maharashtra: CFR → better conservation, higher MFP income, women's empowerment, reduced Naxal influence

Committees: Kailas Sarup (2006) → paved way | Saxena Committee (2010) → found systemic non-implementation | N.C. Saxena: conservation and rights are compatible

BB-09 DISPLACEMENT & REHABILITATION

PYQ: "Development induced displacement" (2020/20), "R&R problems" (2021/15), "Dam displacement — women" (2023/15), "Displacement & health" (2017/20)

Walter Fernandes (2007): 60M displaced (1947–2004) | **40% tribal** (though 8% of population) | **75% not rehabilitated**

Cernea's 8 Impoverishment Risks

Risk	Tribal Context
1. Landlessness	Land is identity, not just asset
2. Joblessness	Forest skills not transferable to cash economy
3. Homelessness	Relocated to unfamiliar terrain
4. Marginalization	Displaced tribals = lowest rung in new location
5. Food insecurity	Loss of forest foods, fishing grounds
6. Increased morbidity	New diseases + loss of traditional medicine + mental health
7. Loss of common property	Forests, rivers — not compensated in cash R&R
8. Social disarticulation	Community bonds, clan/village unit destroyed

Impact on Women

- Loss of forest → loss of economic autonomy (women = primary MFP collectors)
- R&R compensation to male head → women excluded from decisions
- Increased vulnerability: trafficking, domestic violence | **Case:** Sardar Sarovar Dam

Key Case Studies

Project	Tribes	Impact
Sardar Sarovar Dam	Bhils, Bhilalas	40,000+ families; NBA (Medha Patkar)
Hirakud Dam	22,000 families	First major displacement; still not rehabilitated
Koel-Karo Dam	Munda, Ho	30+ years resistance → project dropped (2010)
Niyamgiri	Dongria Kondh (PVTG)	Gram Sabha rejected Vedanta mining (2013) — landmark

R&R Legislation

Act	Key Features	Limitations
LAA 1894	Colonial "eminent domain" — no consent, no R&R	Grossly inadequate
RFCTLARR 2013	70/80% consent; R&R mandatory; SIA; 2-4x compensation	Implementation weak; CPR recognition poor

BB-10

CONSTITUTIONAL SAFEGUARDS — V & VI SCHEDULES

PYQ: "V and VI Schedules" (2016/20), "Governor in V Schedule" (2015/10, 2022/10), "VI Schedule provisions" (2020/15), "Status of VI Schedule areas" (2024/10)

Fifth vs Sixth Schedule

Aspect	Fifth Schedule	Sixth Schedule
Region	10 states — Peninsular/Central India	4 NE states (Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram)
Governance	Governor + TAC (advisory only, 20 members, 3/4 ST)	Elected ADCs (30 members) with real powers
Legislative	Governor can modify/annul laws	ADCs can make laws on land, forests, customs, marriage
Judicial	None	Village/district courts for tribal disputes
Land	Governor can prohibit transfer	ADC controls allotment
Autonomy	Limited — executive discretion	Substantial — legislative + judicial + executive
PESA link	PESA (1996) extends to V Schedule areas	Not applicable (ADCs serve similar purpose)
Limitation	Governor rarely uses power; TAC ignored	Limited financial autonomy; dependent on state grants

Key Constitutional Articles for STs

Article	Provision
Art. 15(4), 16(4)	Special provisions + reservation in employment
Art. 19(5)	Restrict non-tribal land/trade in Scheduled Areas
Art. 46	Promote educational & economic interests
Art. 275	Central grants for tribal welfare
Art. 330, 332	Reserved seats in Lok Sabha & State Assemblies
Art. 338A	NCST — constitutional body (89th Amendment, 2003)
Art. 342, 366(25)	President specifies STs; definition of ST
Art. 371A-H	Special provisions for NE states

BB-11

ETHNICITY & ETHNIC CONFLICTS

PYQ: "Concept of ethnicity" (2020/10), "Ethnic identity vs ethnicity" (2023/15), "Ethno-nationalism" (2014/15, 2024/15)

Three Theoretical Perspectives

Approach	Core Idea	Scholar
Primordial	Ethnic identity is given — blood, kinship, language; deeply emotional	Clifford Geertz
Instrumentalist	Ethnicity is a political tool — elites mobilize for power	Paul Brass, Abner Cohen
Situated Primordial	Real identity BUT context-dependent — activated situationally	Fredrik Barth (ethnic boundaries)

Barth (1969): Ethnicity defined by boundary maintenance ("us" vs "them"), not cultural content. Groups change culture but maintain boundary. **Surajit Sinha:** Tribal identity strengthened through contact with state.

Causes of Ethnic Conflicts in Tribal Areas

1. Land & resource alienation (core grievance)
2. Cultural domination by mainstream society
3. Political marginalization despite reservation
4. Exploitative intermediaries (moneylenders, contractors)
5. Identity threat from non-tribal in-migration
6. Development-induced displacement
7. State repression (AFSPA, paramilitary)

Major Movements

Movement	Tribe/Region	Outcome
Jharkhand Movement	Santhal, Munda, Ho	Separate state achieved (2000)
Naga Movement	Nagas / Nagaland	Armed separatism since 1950s; Naga Accord 2015 (unresolved)
Mizo Movement	Mizos / Mizoram	Mizo Accord (1986) → peace + statehood — most successful
Bodo Movement	Bodos / Assam	Bodo Accord (2020) → BTR
Santhal Rebellion (1855)	Santhals / Bihar	Against dikus; led by Sidho-Kanho
Birsa Munda Ulgulan (1899)	Mundas / Chotanagpur	Against land alienation; Birsa = "Dharti Aba"

BB-12 IMPACT OF RELIGIONS ON TRIBES

PYQ: One religion asked every year. Hinduism (2015, 2020), Christianity (2014, 2017, 2021), Buddhism (2019), Islam (2016), "Consequences of contact" (2022)

A) Hinduism

Aspect	Detail
Process	Sanskritization — adopt Hindu customs, deities to gain higher status
Positive	Social mobility; access to larger civilization; pilgrimage networks
Negative	Loss of egalitarian ethos; caste hierarchy introduced; women's status declines (veil adoption)
Scholar	Surajit Sinha: Tribe-caste continuum — not separate systems but poles of a continuum
Case study	Bhils: Hindu deities + tribal spirits; Holi/Diwali + Bhil rituals; Rajput-Bhil continuum

B) Christianity

Aspect	Detail
Positive	Education (mission schools); healthcare; script for unwritten languages; anti-witch-hunting
Negative	Cultural alienation; intra-tribal division (converts vs non-converts); dependency on missions
Demographics	Nagaland 88%, Mizoram 87%, Meghalaya 75% Christian
Revivalist reactions	Tana Bhagat (Oraon, 1914), Sarna Movement, Donyi-Polo (Arunachal)
Case study	Nagas: Christianity unified diverse tribes but replaced morung, head-hunting, traditional authority

C) Buddhism

- Syncretic absorption in eastern tribal India | Neo-Buddhist movement (Ambedkar, 1956) — some Gonds adopted
- Tribal practices (non-violence, nature worship) compatible with Buddhism | **Case:** Chakma (Tripura) — Theravada Buddhist tribe

D) Islam

- **Examples:** Siddis (Sufi Islam), Bakarwals (pastoral), Lakshadweep (matrilineal + Muslim)
- Trade contact + Sufi influence; geographically limited compared to Hinduism/Christianity
- Lakshadweep: Islam + matriliney — property through mother's line (unusual in Islamic context)

BB-13 ELWIN-GHURYE DEBATE & APPROACHES

PYQ: "Elwin-Ghurye debate" (2015/10), "Views of Ghurye and Elwin" (2022/20), "Tribal Panchsheel relevance" (2015/10), "Shifting terrains of tribal policies" (2023/20)

Three Approaches

Approach	Champion	Core Idea	Criticism
Isolationist	Elwin (early)	Protect from outside contact; "national parks" for culture	Museum pieces; denies development
Assimilationist	G.S. Ghurye	Tribes = "backward Hindus"; merge into mainstream	Denies identity; cultural imperialism
Integrationist	Nehru + Elwin (later)	Integrate while respecting culture — develop along own genius	Adopted as official policy

Elwin vs Ghurye

Aspect	Verrier Elwin	G.S. Ghurye
View	Unique, independent cultures	"Backward Hindus"
Solution	Protection from exploitation	Education, intermarriage, assimilation
Work	Lived with Baigas & Gonds; fieldwork	Academic; "The Scheduled Tribes" (1943)
Policy influence	Shaped Tribal Panchsheel; NEFA advisor	Influenced Hindu nationalist view
Evolution	Isolationist → Integrationist	Remained assimilationist

Nehru's Tribal Panchsheel (5 Principles)

1. **Develop along their own genius** — don't impose alien values
2. **Respect rights in land and forests**
3. **Train tribal people for administration**
4. **Don't over-administer** — work through tribal institutions
5. **Judge by human character, not statistics**

Relevance today: All 5 principles violated in practice — mainstream curriculum, continued land alienation, over-bureaucratized programmes, success by expenditure not outcomes. But remains relevant as guiding framework.

BB-14 PVTGs (PARTICULARLY VULNERABLE TRIBAL GROUPS)

PYQ: "Concept of PTG/PVTG" (2014/10, 2017/10), "Problems of PVTGs" (2023/20), "Recent welfare measures" (2024/20)

75 groups across 18 states | Originally PTGs (Dhebar Commission, 1960-61) → renamed **PVTGs in 2006** ("primitive" = derogatory, colonial)

3 Identification Criteria

1. Pre-agricultural technology (hunter-gatherers, shifting cultivators)
2. Declining or stagnant population
3. Very low literacy (below ST average)

Important PVTGs

PVTG	State	Key Feature
Sentinelese	North Sentinel Island	Uncontacted; hostile to outsiders
Jarawa	Andaman	Semi-contacted since 1998; disease vulnerable
Great Andamanese	Andaman	Near-extinct (~43); 10 languages → 1-2 remain
Chenchu	Telangana/AP	Forest gatherers; threatened by tiger reserves
Birhor	Jharkhand	Rope-making, monkey hunting; nomadic
Baiga	MP/Chhattisgarh	Resist plough (wounding Mother Earth); bewar cultivators
Toda	Tamil Nadu (Nilgiris)	Pastoral; polyandrous; sacred dairy temples
Dongria Kondh	Odisha (Niyamgiri)	Resisted Vedanta mining; fruit orchards
Saharia	Rajasthan/MP	Largest PVTG (~4.5 lakh)

Problems

1. Demographic decline (disease vulnerability, low fertility)
2. Habitat destruction (mining, deforestation, dams)
3. Food insecurity + no PDS reach
4. No healthcare access; malaria, TB, sickle cell
5. Isolation paradox (need protection + need services)
6. Language death + cultural erosion

Government Schemes

- **PM-JANMAN (2023):** Rs 24,000 crore — housing, water, healthcare, education, roads for all 75 PVTGs
- **CCD Plans:** Micro-plans tailored to each PVTG
- **FRA 2006:** Habitat rights specifically for PVTGs

Why "Primitive" was problematic: Rooted in 19th-century evolutionism (Morgan, Tylor). Implies frozen in time, inferior. "Particularly Vulnerable" = rights-based framing focusing on structural vulnerability, not cultural judgment.

BB-15 PESA & GRAM SABHA

PYQ: "PESA & women's political participation" (2024/15), "Tribal Council vs Gram Sabha" (2022/15), "PESA vs VI Schedule" (2018/15)

Background: 73rd Amendment (1992) excluded Scheduled Areas. Bhuria Committee (1995) → PESA enacted 1996.

Key PESA Features

- Gram Sabha = foundation — approves plans, identifies beneficiaries
- Consent for land acquisition + MFP ownership + moneylending regulation
- Customary law preserved + mining lease consultation mandatory

Traditional Council vs Gram Sabha

Aspect	Traditional Council	Gram Sabha (PESA)
Origin	Customary, centuries-old	Statutory, created by law
Membership	Clan elders, hereditary chiefs	All adult residents
Women	Often excluded (exceptions: Khasi)	1/3 reservation mandated
Decision-making	Consensus, elder authority	Democratic voting
Strength	Deep cultural legitimacy	Legal backing + financial powers
Weakness	Conservative, gender-unequal	Bureaucratic capture; poor awareness

PESA vs VI Schedule

Feature	PESA	VI Schedule
Region	V Schedule (10 states, Central)	4 NE states
Body	Gram Sabha + Panchayats	Autonomous District Councils
Legislative power	No — consultative + consent	Yes — ADCs make laws
Scope	Village level	District level

BB-16 NGOs IN TRIBAL DEVELOPMENT

PYQ: "Role of NGOs" (2014, 2016, 2019), "NGOs critiqued for interfering" (2015/20), "NGOs empowering tribal women" (2021/15)

Positive Contributions

Area	NGO	Work
Education	Barefoot College (Bunker Roy)	Tribal women trained as solar engineers
Health	SEARCH, Gadchiroli (Abhay Bang)	Neonatal mortality reduction; community health workers
Legal rights	Vasundhara, Kalpavriksh	FRA implementation support
Livelihoods	PRADAN	SHGs among tribal women; sericulture, lac cultivation
Advocacy	Survival International	Sentinelese, Jarawa protection
Women	Seva Mandir, SEWA	SHGs among Bhil women; organized informal workers

Criticisms

1. Foreign funding agenda — donor priorities, not tribal needs (FCRA tightened)
2. Religious conversion through education/health — intra-tribal division
3. Environmental NGOs blocking projects → tribals lose employment (counter: tribals themselves resist)
4. Dependency creation; unaccountable; cultural imposition
5. IB Report (2014): Accused NGOs of stalling GDP growth

Balanced view: NGOs fill vacuum where state fails. Best model: build capacity, then withdraw (PRADAN). Partnership: NGO + State + Community (tripartite).

BB-17 ROLE OF ANTHROPOLOGY IN DEVELOPMENT

PYQ: Asked EVERY YEAR. "Tribal & rural development" (2018/20), "Anthropological perspective on development" (2022/15), "Nation building" (2023/15)

Why Anthropology is Essential

1. **Holistic understanding:** Community as whole system (economy + kinship + religion + ecology)
2. **Emic perspective:** What development means TO the community
3. **Participant observation:** Ground realities that surveys miss
4. **Cultural sensitivity:** Identifies barriers & facilitators
5. **Community participation:** PRA, PLA methods
6. **Conflict mediation:** Understands inter-community dynamics

Contributions to Tribal Development

Area	Contribution
FRA implementation	Ethnographic mapping of community forest resources
PVTG programs	Micro-plans based on ethnographic understanding
Health	Ethno-medicine integration; SEARCH Gadchiroli model
Education	Multilingual education; culturally appropriate curriculum
R&R programs	Social Impact Assessment (SIA) under RFCTLARR 2013
Rural development	PRA/PLA (Robert Chambers); Green Revolution critique; peasant economy understanding

Key Scholars

Scholar	Contribution
S.C. Dube	"India's Changing Villages" (1958)
L.P. Vidyarthi	"Applied Anthropology in India"
K.S. Singh	People of India Project — largest anthropological survey
Virginius Xaxa	Xaxa Committee (2014) — rights-based approach

Strengths & Weaknesses

Strengths	Weaknesses
Combines bio + cultural + linguistic + archaeological	Small-scale focus — hard to scale to policy
Deep fieldwork vs survey snapshot	Time-intensive — planners want quick answers
Comparative method — cross-cultural learning	Sometimes romanticizes tradition
Ethical commitment to community	Academic language inaccessible to policymakers

Conclusion template: "Anthropology provides the cultural compass that technical programmes lack. Without it, development = imposition; with it, development = empowerment." — S.C. Dube's "human dimension of development"

BB-18 COMMUNALISM & REGIONALISM

PYQ: "Anthropological understanding of communalism" (2019/10), "Regionalism — opportunity & threat" (2022/10), "Secularism vs religiosity vs fundamentalism" (2024/15)

Communalism

Definition: Ideology treating religious community as political entity — assumes common secular interests opposed to other religious groups.

- **T.N. Madan:** Secularism is "impossible, impractical, impotent" for deeply religious societies
- **Geertz:** Religion as cultural system → communal when politicized
- **Veena Das:** Communal violence = organized political action, not irrational mob frenzy
- **Tribal context:** Tribes less susceptible (animistic, syncretic) but conversion politics creates tensions

Regionalism

Type	Description	Example
Positive	Celebrates diversity; drives decentralization	New states (Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh)
Negative	Threatens integration; separatism	Early Naga movement
Autonomist	More powers within existing system	Bodo, Gorkha demands

Secularism vs Religiosity vs Fundamentalism vs Spiritualism

Concept	Definition
Secularism	Separation of religion from governance; Indian: equal respect for all (sarva dharma sambhava)
Religiosity	Personal devotion without political dimension; tribes = deeply religious but not fundamentalist
Fundamentalism	Rigid literal interpretation; political mobilization; anti-pluralist
Spiritualism	Inner quest beyond organized religion; tribal animism is closest to this

BB-19 DEVELOPMENTAL PROGRAMMES

PYQ: "Tribal Sub Plan" (2017/15), "ITDP objectives" (2022/20), "Development programmes — social transformation" (2016/15)

Programme	Year	Features	Limitations
TSP	1974	Proportional fund allocation as per ST population %	Funds diverted; "notional" allocation
ITDP	1974	Area-based; blocks with 50%+ ST; infrastructure + livelihood	Top-down; ignored tribal knowledge
MADA	1979	50%+ ST areas not under ITDP	Underfunded
EMRS	1998	Model residential schools; 740 sanctioned	Quality varies; cultural gap
Van Bandhu KY	2014	Umbrella; outcome-oriented; 12 ministry convergence	Monitoring challenges
MFP-MSP	2014	Fair price for forest produce via TRIFED	Procurement weak
Van Dhan VK	2018	SHG-based MFP processing; tribal entrepreneurship	Market linkages weak
PM-JANMAN	2023	Rs 24,000 cr for PVTGs — housing, water, health	Too early to assess

Common Criticisms

1. Top-down — designed without local consultation
2. Fund leakage — TSP funds diverted to general schemes
3. Welfare vs rights approach (need shift to FRA-type rights model)
4. Ignores heterogeneity (705 STs treated as one)
5. Success by expenditure, not outcomes (violates Panchsheel P5)
6. Intermediary capture by elites, contractors, officials

BB-20

TRIBE & NATION STATE

PYQ: "Tribal unrest as tribe-state incompatibility" (2019/20), "Tribe vs indigenous in other countries" (2017/20), "ILO Convention 169" (2024/10)

Core Tension

Nation-State Logic	Tribal Logic
Uniform citizenship	Community-based identity
Written law	Customary law (oral, elder-interpreted)
Individual property rights	Communal ownership
Resource extraction for GDP	Resources are sacred, inalienable
Progress = economic indicators	Progress = ecological sustainability + cultural continuity

ILO Convention 169 (1989)

- Key principles: Self-identification, consultation, FPIC (Free Prior Informed Consent)
- Recognize collective land rights + consent before projects + right to return
- 24 ratifiers (mostly Latin American) | **India NOT a signatory**
- India's argument: Constitutional provisions sufficient; rejects "indigenous" label

"Indigenous" vs "Tribe" — Comparative

Country	Term	Key Features
India	Scheduled Tribe	Rejects "indigenous" label — no settler-native dichotomy
Australia	Aboriginal	Native Title Act; Mabo; Stolen Generation; 2023 Voice referendum rejected
USA/Canada	Native American / First Nations	Treaty-based sovereignty; reservation system; self-governance
Latin America	Pueblos Indigenas	ILO 169 ratified; Bolivia = plurinational state

Way forward: Not "tribe OR state" but negotiated coexistence. V/VI Schedule, PESA, FRA show the path — implementation is key.

CROSS-CUTTING: ANSWER TEMPLATES & SCHOLAR TOOLKIT

Answer Templates

Marks	Word Count	Structure
10 marks	150–200	Definition + 3-4 key points + 1 scholar/case study + 1 line conclusion
15 marks	250–300	Definition + context + 5-6 points with examples + 2 scholars + case study + way forward
20 marks	400–500	Intro (define + context) + Body (multiple dimensions, scholars, case studies) + Criticism + Way forward + Conclusion

Universal Scholars — Drop in Any Answer

Scholar	Use For
Verrier Elwin	Any isolation/protection argument
G.S. Ghurye	Any assimilation/integration argument
Nehru	Tribal Panchsheel, integrationist approach
B.D. Sharma	Tribal exploitation, poverty, "unfinished task"
Walter Fernandes	Displacement statistics (60M/40%/75%)
K.S. Singh	People of India Project, ethnic identity
Virginus Xaxa	Contemporary tribal policy, rights-based approach
Michael Cernea	Displacement IRR model (8 risks)
M.N. Srinivas	Sanskritization of tribes
Surajit Sinha	Tribe-caste continuum, tribal movements

